

Business Data Checklist

A practical pre-dashboard checklist for small businesses and growing teams.

Before you build reports or dashboards, make sure you know what data your business actually collects.

Sales & Revenue

- Order or invoice date
- Product or service name
- Quantity sold
- Selling price
- Discounts, if applicable
- Customer or customer segment
- Sales channel
- Payment method

Costs & Profitability

- Product or service cost
- Operating expenses
- Shipping or delivery costs
- Payment processing fees
- Taxes where relevant
- Gross profit or contribution margin

Customer Data

- Customer identifier
- New vs returning customer
- Location or market
- Purchase frequency
- Average order value
- Customer acquisition source

Data Quality Checks

- Dates use one consistent format

- Currency values are stored as numbers
- Duplicate rows are reviewed
- Missing values are identified
- Product/customer names use consistent spelling
- Totals can be reconciled with source records

Dashboard Readiness

- You can filter data by date
- Important KPIs have clear definitions
- The data has enough history for useful comparisons
- You know which decisions each dashboard should support